

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

CHANGING FACE OF POLITICS

The BJP's central leadership is increasingly facing personality clashes in state units. In Tripura, despite an easy victory under incumbent chief minister Manik Saha, a section in the state wanted him replaced by Union minister Pratima Bhoumik. In Karnataka, CM Basavaraj Bommai should worry as ex-CM B.S. Yediyurappa gets appointed as BJP campaign chief. The demand for change in leadership is coming from other poll-bound states too, like in Madhya Pradesh where CM Shivraj Chouhan is completing his fourth term. Having pocketed Tripura, the BJP must resolve the leadership tussle in these states to get favourable outcomes in the assembly polls scheduled later this year. The 2018 outing was not so good for the saffron side.

BANKING ON INDIANS



India is poised to become the world's third largest economy and drive one-fifth of global growth by 2027, says a recent Morgan Stanley report. It should be no surprise then that three Indians will hold the reins at the World Bank by May this year. **Ajay Banga**, an Indian-born American corporate honcho, has been appointed president; Indian national Indermit Gill is currently senior vice president and chief economist, and former IAS officer Parameswaran Iyer is set to join as executive director. Interestingly, all three are alumni of St Stephen's College and sons of former officers of the Indian armed forces. Banga's father Lt Gen. H.S. Banga and Gill's father Lt Gen. I.S. Gill were in the army and Iyer's father Air Marshal P.V. Iyer in the IAF.

Flying Accusation

On March 1, the birthday of Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar and his Tamil Nadu counterpart **M.K. Stalin**, Deputy CM **Tejashwi Yadav** flew to Chennai to wish the latter. Two days later, Leader of the Opposition and BJP leader Vijay Sinha took Nitish's deputy to task in the assembly for flying to Chennai to cut a cake but doing nothing about attacks on Bihari labourers in the state. Tejashwi's retort? "*Adaniji ke plane mein nahin baithe hain.*" No guessing where that missive was headed.



ANI

Kaushik Deka with Anilesh S. Mahajan, Dhaval Kulkarni, Ashish Misra and Amitabh Srivastava



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Seemingly innocuous acts can acquire a different hue in the age of social media. **Sunil Prabhu**, an MLA of the Uddhav Thackeray faction of the Shiv Sena, was having a cordial conversation with Prabhakar Kale, personal secretary of CM Eknath Shinde, at the Maharashtra legislature secretariat when Shinde came towards them with a posse of mediapersons in tow. Mindful of the stir that he, Kale and Shinde in the same frame might cause, Prabhu made a hasty exit.

Yogi's Do-All



There's no doubting who Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath's favourite babu these days is—**Manoj Kumar Singh**, an IAS officer of the 1988 batch. On April 30, 2022, Yogi made Singh the agriculture production commissioner, the second most important position after Chief Secretary. Shortly after, he was also given charge of the panchayati raj department and made additional chief secretary of the horticulture department. Recently, on February 28, Yogi made Singh the infrastructure and industrial development commissioner, and the next day, the chairman of the Pradeshiya Industrial and Investment Corporation. He's now in charge of the highest number of departments in UP.